

Python - Keyword-Only Arguments

Keyword-Only Arguments

You can use the **variables** in formal argument list as keywords to pass value. Use of **keyword arguments** is optional. But, you can force the function to accept arguments by keyword only. You should put an asterisk (*) before the keyword-only arguments list.

Let us say we have a function with three arguments, out of which we want second and third arguments to be keyword-only. For that, put * after the first argument.

Example of Keyword-Only Arguments

The **built-in print() function** is an example of keyword-only arguments. You can give list of expressions to be printed in the parentheses. The printed values are separated by a white space by default. You can specify any other separation character instead using **"sep"** argument.

```
print ("Hello", "World", sep="-")
```

It will print –

```
Hello-World
```

Example: Using "sep" as non-keyword Argument

The **sep** argument of the **print()** function is keyword-only. Try using it as non-keyword argument.

```
print ("Hello", "World", "-")
```

You'll get different output, not as desired –

```
Hello World -
```

Using Keyword-Only argument in User-Defined Method

To make an argument keyword-only, put the astreisk (*) before it while creating the user-defined function.

Those Python functions that are defined by us within a given class to perform certain actions are called as user-defined function. They are not predefined by Python.

Example

In the following user defined function "**intr()**" the "**rate**" argument is keyword-only. To call this function, the value for **rate** must be passed by keyword.

```
def intr(amt,*, rate):  
    val = amt*rate/100  
    return val  
  
interest = intr(1000, rate=10)  
print(interest)
```

```
100.0
```

However, if you try to use the default positional way of calling the above function, you will encounter an error.

Example

The code below shows it is not possible to use positional arguments when keyword-only arguments are required.

```
def intr(amt, *, rate):
    val = amt * rate / 100
    return val

interest = intr(1000, 10)
print(interest)
```

On executing, this code will show the following result –

```
interest = intr(1000, 10)
                ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
TypeError: intr() takes 1 positional argument but 2 were given
```

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